

Instructor: ..... Date: .....

Learner: ..... Regional Branch: .....

Program: ..... Center: .....

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### Let's Start!

#### Technology Breakdown!



#### Learning Outcome

Exchange information about hypothetical situations in written and spoken interactions according to work and social contexts.

#### Can Do Statements

- I can discuss coincidences and strange events.
- I can express opinions and beliefs.
- I can ask and offer help with technical problems.

#### Ask your partner:

- What kinds of problems have you had with your computer?
- Who do you ask for help when you have computer problems?





## Let's Explore!

Peter needs some technical **know-how**\*

\* "Know-how" means knowledge or skills.



*Instructions: Read the text aloud.*

**Peter:** Hello?

**Vanessa:** Hi Peter. Guess what? I just got the text that you sent yesterday. Isn't that bizarre? And I got it at precisely the same time that you sent it yesterday, but a day later.

**Peter:** Hmmm. That is weird. I think there's something wrong with my phone. I received a text this morning from a friend, asking me to come to his house at 9:00 a.m. I went to his house and he answered the door in his pyjamas. I showed him the text that I had received. He started laughing and said that he sent that text a month ago. I just received it today! He said he was wondering why I never showed up at his place.

**Vanessa:** Oh Peter. Have you backed up your phone? Maybe it's time for a new one.

**Peter:** And a new computer.

**Vanessa:** What do you mean? Do you need some help with your laptop?

**Peter:** Yes, that's why I'm calling. I wonder if you could do me a favor.

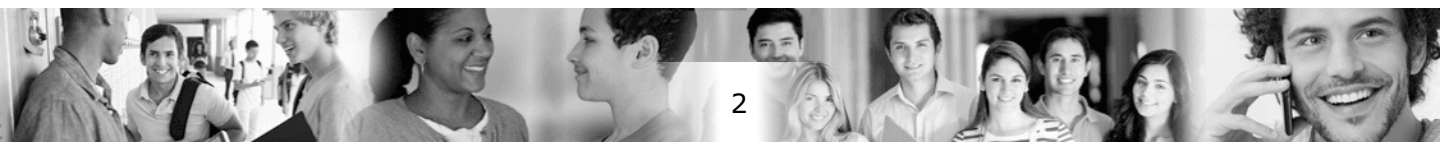
**Vanessa:** Sure. What can I do?

**Peter:** Can I ask you to send me an e-mail? Every time I try to reply to an e-mail the reply goes to a different person. There's some sort of glitch.

**Vanessa:** Actually, now that you mention it, I have received some odd e-mails from you. I was wondering why you were sending me an e-mail asking if I knew any single women that I could introduce you to.

**Peter:** Yeah, that's because they weren't for you. Oh, this is mortifying. That e-mails I wrote to one friend are going to another is very worrying.

**Vanessa:** Okay, well tell me how I can help. Let's do a test and we'll try to figure this out.





## Let's Practice!

Peter and Vanessa are talking about the phone's glitches!

*Instructions: Circle the correct words to complete the sentences. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.*

- 1) I just got the text **that you sent / you send / that you send** yesterday.
- 2) I got it at precisely **same time / the same time that / at the same time** you sent it yesterday.
- 3) **I think there's / I thought there's / I think there** something wrong with my phone.
- 4) I showed him the text that **had received. / I had received. / which I received.**
- 5) **That e-mails I wrote / E-mails I wrote / That e-mails I write** to one friend are going to another is very worrying.



## Let's Practice!

Vanessa is a good friend! She is trying to help Peter.

*Instructions: Choose the words from the word bank to correctly complete the sentences. Read the complete sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.*

### Word Bank

- What can I do?
- Can I ask you to
- if you could do
- how I can help
- need some help

- 1) Do you \_\_\_\_\_ with your laptop?
- 2) I wonder \_\_\_\_\_ me a favor.
- 3) Sure. \_\_\_\_\_
- 4) \_\_\_\_\_ send me an e-mail?
- 5) Okay, well tell me \_\_\_\_\_.



## Extension Activity

Make a list of technology solutions.

*Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.*

- On a piece of paper, write down five possible things that could go wrong with different types of technology.
- Get together with a partner and show him or her your list.
- Together, talk about some ways to solve each of your technological problems.
- Do the same with your partner's list of technological problems.

### Self-Assessment

**Yes** **No**

I make a list of technological problems.

☐ ☐

I discuss solutions to technological problems with a partner.

☐ ☐

I make suggestions and give advice.

☐ ☐


## Target Words

- odd** (adjective): strange or unexpected  
e.g. I have received some odd e-mails from you.
- to back up** (verb): to copy information to a separate location in case the original copy is lost or damaged  
e.g. Have you backed up your phone?
- glitch** (noun): a problem or fault  
e.g. There's some sort of glitch.
- bizarre** (adjective): unconventional; eccentric  
e.g. Isn't that bizarre?
- mortifying** (adjective): very embarrassing  
e.g. Oh, this is mortifying.
- precisely** (adverb): exactly accurate  
e.g. I got it at precisely the same time that you sent it yesterday.



## Learning Points

### **That Clauses as the Subject or Object**

You usually use *that*-clauses to talk about facts or beliefs.

*That*-clauses can be placed in different parts of the sentence, depending on what you want to communicate.

*That*-clauses can be the subject of the sentence. You normally use this structure in formal writing or speaking.

For example:

***That we don't care*** *is simply not true.*

It is more common to use the structure *It ... that ...*

For example:

***It is simply not true that we don't care.***

When you use a *that*-clause as the object (after reporting verbs), you often omit *that*.

For example:

*She promised (that) she would come.*

### **Examples:**

- *I just got the text (that) you sent yesterday.*
- *I got it at the exact same time (that) you sent it yesterday.*
- *I think (that) there's something wrong with my phone.*
- *I showed him the text (that) I had received.*





## Learning Points

### Asking for and Offering Help with Technical Problems

There are many ways to ask for and offer help in English. Some are more formal than others.

|                 | Offering Help                                                                                                                                                                                            | Examples                                                                                                                                                                      |
|-----------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Asking for Help | <i>Could you do me a favor?</i><br><i>Could I ask you a favor?</i><br><i>Can I ask you to ... ?</i><br><i>I need some help (if you have time).</i><br><i>(If you're not busy) I could use your help.</i> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• <i>Do you need some help with your laptop?</i></li> <li>• <i>What can I do?</i></li> <li>• <i>Tell me how I can help.</i></li> </ul> |
| Offering Help   | <i>May I help you?</i><br><i>Can I help you?</i><br><i>Are you looking for something?</i><br><i>Would you like some help?</i><br><i>Do you need some help?</i><br><i>What can I do for you today?</i>    | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• <i>I wonder if you could do me a favor.</i></li> <li>• <i>Can I ask you to send me an e-mail?</i></li> </ul>                         |

